



Worlds bronze shows Satwik-Chirag's growth, and what's missing

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Since their Paris Olympics heartbreak last August, the Indian men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty have lived through a year of near-misses. Twelve tournaments, six semifinal exits. The Asian Games gold medallists couldn't convert deep runs

into titles – their last triumph was the 2024 Thailand Open – as they battled through personal tragedy and persistent injuries: Rankireddy's stubborn shoulder and Shetty's troubled back. But the long wait for a podium finish finally ended, fittingly, in the French capital.

At the 2025 BWF World

Championships quarterfinals, Rankireddy and Shetty defeated Malaysia's Aaron Chia and Soh Wooi Yik 21-12, 21-19 to secure a bronze medal – their second at the Worlds. It was particularly sweet, as Chia and Soh had crushed their medal hopes at the Paris Games. Heading into the clash, the Indians trailed the

Bronze in Paris brings **redemption** for Satwik-Chirag, yet their struggles with pressure reveal the next hurdle in their journey.